

Church of San Giorgio Maggiore

Location Venice, Italy

The glory of Andrea Palladio's Church of San Giorgio Maggiore, built between 1566 and 1610, is its commanding facade, which towers over the wide waters of St. Mark's Canal facing the Doge's Palace (see pp.144–145). It presents an extremely satisfying solution to a perennial problem facing Renaissance architects: how to reconcile a Classical temple front with the liturgical demands of a Christian church, with a high nave and lower aisles. Palladio's answer was to use two pediments: a high central one for the nave, superimposed on a lower, broken pediment for the aisles. The four three-quarter composite columns of the central

pediment are raised on vast bases. Five similarly oversized sculptures adorn the roof-line.

Basilica Palladiana

Location Vicenza, Italy

The grandeur that Andrea Palladio so effortlessly achieved in his creations is typified by the Basilica Palladiana. Built in stages between 1549 and 1617, although entirely to Palladio's designs, it forms a screen around Vicenza's 15th-century Palace of Justice. Arranged over two stories, it consciously aims to recreate the nobility of a Roman public building. Both stories—the lower Doric and the upper Ionic—consist of nine arched bays separated by 10 half-columns. The arches are supported by

smaller free-standing columns set in slightly from the wall to create what are sometimes called Serlian or Palladian windows. Balustrades run between the openings on the upper story and along the length of a roof-line studded with statues. The roof is memorably copper clad.

Onze Lieve Vrouwekerk

Location Scherpenheuvel, Belgium

Onze Lieve Vrouwekerk, or the Church of Our Lady, built between 1609 and 1627, was the first fully Classical building in what was then the Spanish Netherlands. It is an imposing, seven-sided structure. A Palladian, arched motif forms the main entrance, flanked by niches between pilasters. The upper story

features a boldly broken pediment. The church's dominant feature is its vast, spreading dome, studded with little metal stars and buttressed by oversized volutes separated by an arched window. At its summit is an elaborate domed lantern. The interior of the church is richly decorated. Its prime focus is a miracle-working statue of the Virgin Mary—discovered in the 13th century—for which the church was built.

The Exchange

Location Copenhagen, Denmark

The Exchange, or Børsen, built between 1625 and 1640, is potent proof of the determination of Christian IV of Denmark to transform the Danish capital. Made of bricks but with seemingly endless

